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PIAGET'S STAGES

Four stages of cognitive development

Jean Piaget's model of how children's thinking develops through four sequential stages.

Mnemonic: Sweet Pre-teens Cook Formally
Sensorimotor, Preoperational , Concrete Operational Stage, Formal Operational Stage

COGNITIVE DISSONANCE

Discomfort from conflicting beliefs

Mental tension arising when a person holds two contradictory beliefs or attitudes simultaneously.

Theory by Leon Festinger, 1957
Resolved by changing belief/behavior

MASLOW'S HIERARCHY

Five-tier pyramid of human needs

Motivation theory ranking needs from basic physiological to self-actualization at the top.

Physiological, Safety, Love and Belonging, Esteem, Self-Actualization
Lower needs met before higher

OPERANT CONDITIONING

Learning through consequences

Behavior is shaped by reinforcement or punishment consequences following the action.

By B.F. Skinner; Skinner box
Reinforcement increases, punishment decreases

CLASSICAL CONDITIONING

Learning via stimulus association

Learning process where a neutral stimulus becomes linked to a response through repeated pairing.

By Ivan Pavlov, dogs experiment
UCS+CS pairing yields CR

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DEFENSE MECHANISMS

Unconscious ways to reduce anxiety

Freudian ego strategies used unconsciously to protect the self from anxiety or distress.

Examples: denial, repression, projection
Operate below conscious awareness

ID, EGO, SUPEREGO

Freud's three-part personality model

Psychoanalytic structure where id seeks pleasure, ego mediates reality, superego enforces morals.

Id: pleasure principle instinct
Superego: internalized moral conscience

ERIKSON'S STAGES

Eight psychosocial development stages

Erik Erikson's lifespan theory describing crises resolved at each stage of psychosocial growth.

First stage: trust vs mistrust
Spans infancy through late adulthood

WORKING MEMORY MODEL

Baddeley's active memory system

Model describing temporary storage and manipulation of information needed for cognitive tasks.

By Baddeley and Hitch, 1974
Includes phonological loop, sketchpad

ATTACHMENT THEORY

Bond between infant and caregiver

John Bowlby's theory on the emotional bond formed between infants and primary caregivers.

Ainsworth's Strange Situation test
Types: secure, avoidant, anxious

BIG FIVE TRAITS

OCEAN model of personality

Five broad dimensions used to describe human personality across most trait models.

Mnemonic: OCEAN
Openness, Conscientious, Extraversion, Agreeableness, Neuroticism

MILGRAM
EXPERIMENT

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STANFORD
PRISON
EXP.

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BYSTANDER
EFFECT

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ZONE
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SELF-FULFILLING
PROPHECY

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GROUPTHINK

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OBJECT
PERMANENCE

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EBBINGHAUS
FORGETTING

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SOCIAL
LOAFING

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FLOW
STATE

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AVAILABILITY
HEURISTIC

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FUND. ATTRIBUTION ERROR Overrating personality, underrating situation Tendency to overemphasize personal traits and underestimate situational factors in others' behavior. Named by Lee Ross, 1977 Applies mainly to others' actions	HALO EFFECT One trait colors overall perception Cognitive bias where perceiving one positive trait causes overestimation of other unrelated traits. Term coined by Edward Thorndike Common in attractiveness judgments	CONFIRMATION BIAS Favoring info that fits beliefs Tendency to search for and interpret information that confirms one's existing beliefs. Common cognitive bias in reasoning Ignores contradicting evidence	BYSTANDER EFFECT Less help with more witnesses Phenomenon where individuals are less likely to help a victim when other people are present. Linked to diffusion of responsibility Studied after Kitty Genovese case	STANFORD PRISON EXP. Roles shape behavior powerfully Philip Zimbardo's study on how assigned roles of guard and prisoner altered participant behavior. Conducted by Philip Zimbardo, 1971 Stopped early due to abuse	MILGRAM EXPERIMENT Obedience to authority study Stanley Milgram's study showing people's willingness to obey authority even causing apparent harm. Conducted at Yale, 1961 Raised major ethics concerns
SELF-FULFILLING PROPHECY Belief causes its own outcome A prediction that causes itself to become true simply because it was expected or believed. Coined by Robert K. Merton Seen in Rosenthal's classroom study	GENERAL ADAPTATION SYN. Three-stage response to stress Hans Selye's model of the body's response to prolonged stress across three sequential stages. Mnemonic: Alarm, Resistance, Exhaustion By Hans Selye, 1936	FIGHT-OR-FLIGHT Body's acute stress response Physiological reaction preparing the body to either confront or flee a perceived threat. Coined by Walter Cannon Triggers adrenaline, cortisol release	MULTIPLE INTELLIGENCES Eight distinct types of intelligence Howard Gardner's theory proposing intelligence exists in multiple distinct independent forms. By Howard Gardner, 1983 Includes musical, spatial, bodily	ZONE OF PROX. DEV. Gap between actual and potential Vygotsky's concept: the gap between what a learner can do alone versus with guidance. By Lev Vygotsky Basis for scaffolding technique	LEARNED HELPLESSNESS Giving up after repeated failure State where an organism stops trying to escape hardship after prior uncontrollable negative events. By Martin Seligman, 1967 Linked to depression research
AVAILABILITY HEURISTIC Judging by easily recalled examples Mental shortcut relying on immediate, memorable examples when evaluating a topic or decision. By Tversky and Kahneman Overestimates vivid, rare events	FLOW STATE Full immersion in an activity A state of complete absorption and focus in an activity, often called being 'in the zone'. By Mihaly Csikszentmihalyi Balances skill level and challenge	SOCIAL LOAFING Less effort in group settings Tendency for individuals to exert less effort when working collectively than alone. Studied by Max Ringelmann Increases with larger group size	FORGETTING CURVE Memory retention decays over time Hermann Ebbinghaus's model showing how memory retention drops sharply without reinforcement. Steepest decline occurs early on Spaced repetition slows decay	OBJECT PERMANENCE Knowing objects exist when hidden Understanding that objects continue to exist even when they can no longer be seen. Develops in sensorimotor stage Key Piaget developmental milestone	GROUPTHINK Harmony overrides critical thinking Faulty decision-making that occurs when group desire for consensus overrides realistic evaluation. Term coined by Irving Janis Leads to poor group decisions